From: d.moreau@northwind.example
To: platform-all@northwind.example
Date: Mon, 10 Aug 2026 08:12:04 +0200
Subject: [INC-5401] postmortem - API issue on 07 Aug

All,

Writing up INC-5401 as agreed. Jira reference is INC-5401 and the follow-up items are under API-2201, API-2202 and API-2203.

What happened

There was an issue in prod on Friday affecting the API layer. Some requests did not behave as expected for a period during the morning and a subset of consumers were impacted. The situation was investigated by the team, appropriate remediation was applied, and normal operation was restored the same day. Impact was limited and largely mitigated by existing controls.

Timeline (CEST, 7 Aug 2026)

```
09:14 — alert API-5XX-RATE fires (threshold 2% over 5 min).
09:17 — d.moreau acknowledges.
09:26 — SEV-3 declared; bridge opened with s.hartmann.
09:48 — correlation found with the 08:55 deployment of api-gateway 7.3.0.
10:02 — decision to roll back to 7.2.4.
10:11 — rollback started.
10:29 — rollback complete across all four availability zones.
10:35 — error rate at baseline.
11:05 — 30 minutes clean; incident closed.
```

Root cause

api-gateway 7.3.0 introduced a stricter JSON body parser. Requests sending a numeric field as a quoted string — which the previous parser accepted and coerced — were rejected with a 500 rather than a 400, and the gateway did not fall back. Two partner integrations send the `quantity` field this way. The change was not called out as breaking in the release notes.

Actions

```
API-2201 — restore lenient coercion behind a per-consumer flag and deprecate it with 90 days' notice. Owner
d.moreau, due 2026-09-04.
API-2202 — contract tests in CI running the top 20 partner request shapes against every gateway release
candidate. Owner t.iversen, due 2026-09-18.
API-2203 — release notes must classify every parser or validation change as breaking or non-breaking before
sign-off. Owner s.hartmann, due 2026-08-28.
```

Regards,
Denis

From: r.bianchi@northwind.example
To: d.moreau@northwind.example
Date: Mon, 10 Aug 2026 09:41:55 +0200
Subject: Re: [INC-5401] postmortem - API issue on 07 Aug

Denis,

The timeline, cause and actions are fine. The 'what happened' section does not tell me what actually broke. Which endpoints? How many requests failed, out of how many? Which two partners, and what did they see — failed orders, or retried ones? Was anything lost?

As written I cannot tell whether this was a nuisance or a serious event, and neither will anyone reading it in six months.

R.

> There was an issue in prod on Friday affecting the API layer. Some
> requests did not behave as expected for a period during the morning and
> a subset of consumers were impacted. The situation was investigated by
> the team, appropriate remediation was applied [...]

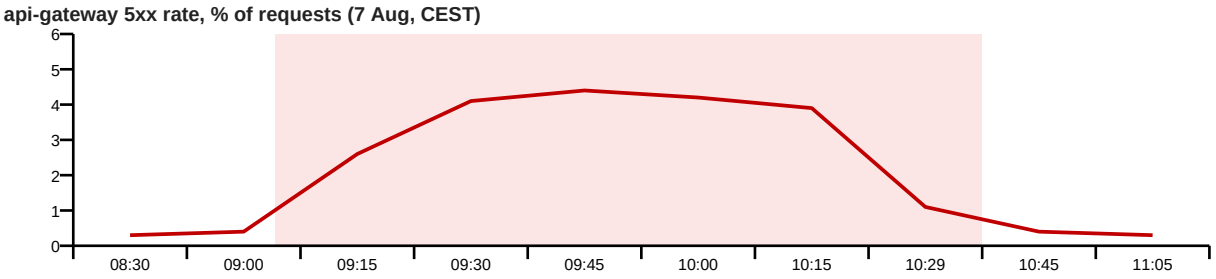
From: d.moreau@northwind.example
To: r.bianchi@northwind.example
Date: Mon, 10 Aug 2026 11:20:31 +0200
Subject: Re: [INC-5401] postmortem - API issue on 07 Aug

Understood. I will get the numbers from the gateway logs and send a revised description this week.

From: compliance@northwind.example
To: records@northwind.example
Date: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 16:02:10 +0200
Subject: FW: [INC-5401] postmortem - API issue on 07 Aug

Filing this thread as the post-incident record for INC-5401. No revised description was received; the Jira issue was closed on 18 August with all three actions marked done.

Attachment: inc-5401-error-rate.png (rendered below)



Rendered from the attachment. Shaded region is the deployment window for api-gateway 7.3.0.